

Do wealthy people have an advantage in court?

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There are many speculations about whether wealthy people have an advantage in the court. Few believe that justice serves fairly without any sort of favor towards anyone, but most people hold very firm beliefs that the system is rigged. This essay is a breakdown of what majority believes.

What system serves?

Our system is carefully crafted to serve justice and fairness to society and to us. They have proved themselves from time to time, making us feel safe and trust the system. It serves us, protects us and make us depend on it. They punish the one who's guilty, serves justice to the victim of the crime. But the question here is, does the same system that we rely on for honesty, fairness and protection is the same one that throws us under the bus for something as trivial as money?

Wealth supremacy

Cartoon: Lawyer says to client sitting in his office: "You have a pretty good case, Mr. Pitkin. How much justice can you afford?"

If one quotation could explain our system well, it will be this. We tend to turn to the prosecution for justice if anything in our lives goes wrong that takes the help of law, and mostly, we get that justice. But let's be honest, justice is not always fair, our system has cracks so deep we don't even know. Let's talk about the obvious first, the tiny "harmless" bribes the officials take. We hear about stuff like this all the time, you get stopped by a patrolling officer, you bribe them and they let you go. Sounds simple? It is not. These are the very first steps people take just for money for any sort, and guess what? It works cause who denies money that comes on your door step to be secretive? So this is basically what happens when some powerful individual gets convicted. This is what happens when money wins over and justice and fairness stands in the corner helplessly. In the court, good defense is the only thing that protects you, and you get that defense from money. Now there are so many examples that proves that our system is fed by money, so many examples that proves that just because an individual didn't have as much money, they lost the case getting convicted for something they never did. It is unfair on so many levels, but that's just how our world works, if you have money, you get it all with an ease. There is a saying that says "everyone has a price." I always wondered what it meant until I grew up, realizing that everything that matters to the society is indeed buyable. The defense can be bought, the evidence can be manufactured, and they entire case can be flipped over in the powerful individual's favor. There was a case in 1980s called "Operation Greylord" in the USA. It implicated that over seventeen judges and dozens of lawyers were involved. The scheme was that the judges accepted bribes to convict innocent people, dismiss cases or fix results. This resulted in the innocent individuals being convicted making the court case seem legitimate while the guilty ones were freed. There is another similar case "Isaac Wright Jr. Case" which took place in New Jersey,

USA. Isaac Wright Jr. was wrongfully convicted and sentenced to life in prison in the late 1980s/early 1990s due to a corrupt judge and prosecutors who manufactured evidence and took bribes. All of these just prove how much of rigged the system is. With these circumstances, how do we make ourselves trust the system? How do we feel safe when it's us who get thrown under the bus between the war of money and justice? This unjust push and pull that cost poor people years of life in prison, even death penalties just for the comfort of money.

Conclusion.

Our current system fails to be fair to the poor. Our trust in the system is as broken as it is. There is an article by 'LEROY D. CLARK' in which he mentions, "There can be no equal justice where the kind of trial a man gets depends on the amount of money he has." It means that justice can't possibly be served fairly to one if money is involved since the person's defense is based on the money he has paid for it. But what if money wasn't involved? What if all the defendants were provided by the states instead of getting appointed by the client? Sounds like a solution until we look at the sixth amendment which guarantees people to appoint their defendants. If we sum it all up, there is nothing we can do to change this rigged system entirely. We can always fight it, sure, but in the end the possibility of power winning over justice is more than the possibility of truth winning. Because in the end, the wealthy ones do have an advantage that stays unshaken.

Sources

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